
IK 569: Mahabharat (Dharma Dasha Lakshanam)

Course Code	IK 569
Course Name	Mahabharat (Dharma Dasha Lakshanam)
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- Week 1-2: **Introduction to the Mahabharata** (4 hours)*
 - Overview of the Mahabharata
 - The authorship and historical context
 - Significance of the Mahabharata in Indian culture
- Week 3-4: **The Pandavas and Kauravas** (4 hours)*
 - Introduction to the Pandavas and Kauravas
 - Birth and early life of the princes
 - Rivalry and conflicts
- Week 5-6: **The Game of Dice** (4 hours)*
 - The fateful game
 - Draupadi's humiliation
 - Yudhishthira's wager
- Week 7-8: **Exile and Adventures** (4 hours)*
 - The Pandavas' exile
 - Encounters with sages and demons
 - Bhima's slaying of Bakasura
- Week 9-10: **The Bhagavad-Gītā** (6 hours)*
 - Context and significance
 - Philosophical teachings of Krishna
 - Arjuna's moral dilemma
- Week 11-12: **Kurukshetra War** (6 hours)*
 - The great battle's preparation
 - Key events and strategies
 - Outcomes and consequences
- Week 13-14: **Aftermath and Bhishma Parva** (4 hours)*
 - The consequences of the war
 - Bhishma's teachings and passing
- Week 15-16: **Drona Parva and Karna Parva** (4 hours)*
 - Dronacharya's role and fall
 - Karna's character and fate
- Week 17-18: **Shalya Parva and Sauptika Parva** (4 hours)*
 - Shalya's involvement

- The night battle and Ashwatthama's actions
- Week 19-20: **Swargarohanika Parva and Conclusion** (4 hours)*
 - Pandvas retire timely
 - Yudhishtira's final journey
 - Lessons from the Mahabharata

Laboratory Modules

- NA

Text and Reference Books

1. C. Rajagopalachari, **Mahabharata**: This is a highly recommended introductory text for those new to the Mahabharata. It provides a condensed yet accessible version of the epic, making it an excellent starting point.
2. Kamala Subramaniam, **Mahabharata**: Kamala Subramaniam's version of the Mahabharata is a popular choice. It offers a detailed retelling of the epic with a focus on character development and moral lessons.
3. Bibek Debroy, **Mahabharata** : Bibek Debroy's translation and commentary offer a scholarly and comprehensive exploration of the Mahabharata. It includes all 18 parvas (books) and provides insights into the historical and cultural context.
4. Carole Satyamurti, **Mahabharata: A Modern Retelling**: This modern retelling of the Mahabharata is written in poetic verse and captures the essence of the epic while making it accessible to contemporary readers.
5. Chaturvedi Badrinath, **The Mahabharata: An Inquiry in the Human Condition**: This book takes a philosophical and moral perspective, exploring the deeper questions raised by the Mahabharata. It's a thoughtful analysis of the epic's significance.
6. R.K. Narayan, **The Mahabharata: A Shortened Modern Prose Version of the Indian Epic**: R.K. Narayan offers a concise and engaging retelling of the Mahabharata in modern prose, making it a great choice for those looking for a shorter version.
7. Bhandarkar, **Mahabharata: The Critical Edition**, Oriental Research Institute: For those interested in a scholarly approach, this edition provides the critical text of the Mahabharata along with detailed notes and commentary.